punch. I don’t mind seeing a bit of anger and angst. It is all part of the mix, and there is no accounting for taste.

It’s odd what gets people worked up. Jelly-beangate, at Trent Bridge in 2007, was weird. A mountain was made out of a molehill when Indian tail-ender Zaheer Khan walked in after the drinks break to find jelly beans in front of his stumps. He thought there were just two, which he swept away with a flourish and a good-natured laugh. In fact, he didn’t notice a third one, beige, in his footmarks.

When he saw it, after the following delivery, he began waving his bat around as though it was a toothpick. He accused KP of throwing the sweet at him while he was batting, something that Kevin theatrically denied. My mugshot was on the back page of the *Sun* the next morning, along with those of Ian Bell and Matty Prior, those closest to the scene of the alleged crime.

‘Who did it?’ screamed the headline. I was at short leg and named in the *Telegraph* as ‘suspect number one’ in some sort of Agatha Christie parody. You couldn’t make it up. Now that the statute of limitations has expired, I can dob in Belly with a clear conscience. It’s always the quiet ones: he thought it would be a laugh to share some of the jelly beans we had eaten during the break in play.

Shahid Afridi bit the ball repeatedly while captaining Pakistan against Australia in Perth. Bottle tops have been surreptitiously used to damage the ball for years. Michael Atherton, England’s answer to Alan Titchmarsh, was caught with dirt in his pocket. I have to say, though, it was a new one on me when Australian opener Cameron Bancroft tried to hide sandpaper down his trousers.

While we’re on the subject of newspaper headlines, a former Aussie Rules player wrote an all-time classic in the Darwin newspaper, the *Northern Territory News* . It featured a full-length front-page photo of Bancroft staring balefully down the front of his pants, accompanied by the headline ‘Why I’ve Got Some Sticky Near My Dicky’. Apparently, an earlier version was ‘Balls on the Line’.

When I first saw the reports, from the third Test against South Africa in Cape Town in March 2018, I knew they were in trouble. We were in New Zealand at the time and, as the story unravelled, the suspicions aroused during the preceding Ashes series in Australia seemed justified. They seemed to have got what was coming to them.